CURIOUS SPAROOWS · ENCYCLOPEDIC INDEX

MUSIC

The complete map of the world's music, from bone flutes to streaming

Traditions of every continent · Hindustani and Carnatic · folk · film · genres · ragas and talas · history · people · awards · ideas · reviews

Parts	Sections	Sub-sections	Entries	Register rows
13	41	104	331	77

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How to Use This Booklet

This booklet is a map of the whole world of music: the classical systems of India and the world, folk and devotional songs, film music, every popular genre, the building blocks of sound, raga and rhythm, history, people, awards and ideas. Every entry tells you, in one or two lines, what the thing is and why it matters.

Every entry has an ID (such as MUS-01.2 for Carnatic music). The same ID is the entry's address on curioussparoows.com, where each one is growing into its own page.

How this booklet is organised

Parts: the intro questions, music of the world, genres, the building blocks, history, people, awards, craft and industry, ideas, reviews, community, navigation and sources.

Sections (MUS-01 to MUS-28): the main topics, each opening with a *Before you start* box.

Sub-sections and entries (☐): one or two lines each; tick the box when you have heard or explored it.

Music Registers: tables of landmark recordings and honours. They are a sourced selection; the full lists grow on the website.

How to explore it

Step 1. Read Part 0, eight two-minute questions about music.

Step 2. Find your own region's music in Part 1, then travel to another continent.

Step 3. Learn the building blocks in Part 3 (swara, raga, tala, harmony).

Step 4. Follow tags and See also links; every instrument links to the Instruments index.

Step 5. Tick ☐ as you listen, and use the tracker at the end.

Our promise

Knowledge belongs to the people who created it. Every fact here stands on a source listed in Part 12, and every "latest" fact says when it was checked. Where something could not be verified, we say so instead of guessing. Found a mistake? Tell us, and we will fix it and thank you.

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PART 0 — THE INTRODUCTION TWIG: WHY DOES VIBRATING AIR MAKE US CRY, DANCE OR PRAY?

About this Part. This is the doorway to the whole Music section of the website, in the tree-twig format of the Curious Sparoons library: one Gateway page, eight Leaves and one Recap. Each Leaf answers one question in about two minutes (250 to 400 words), shows its short answer first and ends with an honest hook to the next question.

MUS-00 The Gateway: Why does a pattern of vibrating air make you cry, dance or pray?

Web address: /music/why-music-moves-us/ · **Keywords:** what is music, why music moves us, music for beginners, history of music

Music is only air pushed into waves. Yet a lullaby calms a baby who knows no words, a drumbeat gets a stadium on its feet, and a raga at dawn can make a grown person weep. Every human culture ever found has music.

This short course follows one question in eight steps: **what is music, and why does it reach so deep inside us?** It goes from bone flutes of the Ice Age to the Samaveda, from the time-of-day ragas to the recording studio, and from the earworm to AI music. Each page takes about two minutes.

By the end you will be able to:

- Explain what sound, pitch and rhythm are in plain words.
- Say why the oldest music came before writing, and maybe before speech.
- Explain why ragas belong to times of day and seasons.
- Describe how recording changed who could hear music.
- Think clearly about whether AI music can move us.

MUS-00.01 What was the first music?

> **Short answer:** The first music was almost certainly the human voice, clapping and body percussion, which leave no trace. The oldest surviving instruments are bone and ivory flutes from Germany, about 40,000 years old.

Keywords: first music ever, oldest musical instrument, prehistoric flute, Divje Babe flute, origin of music

Music before instruments

Singing, humming, clapping and stamping need no tools, so they were surely first. Hunter-gatherer peoples today, such as the BaAka of Central Africa, sing complex layered songs with voices alone.

The oldest instruments we have

Flutes made from vulture bone and mammoth ivory, found in caves such as **Hohle Fels** and **Geissenklösterle** in Germany, date to about 40,000–43,000 years ago. A bone from **Divje Babe** in Slovenia (about 50,000–60,000 years old) has holes that some call a Neanderthal flute; many scientists think a cave bear chewed it.

Early India

Rock shelters at **Bhimbetka** (Madhya Pradesh) contain paintings of dancing figures and possibly drums. Some boulders in India and elsewhere ring like bells when struck ("ringing rocks"), which may have been used as lithophones. The Indus civilisation left a famous bronze "dancing girl" and figurines that suggest music and dance.

Why it matters

Music is not a late luxury. It appears as early as art itself, which suggests it did something vital for early humans: bonding groups, soothing babies, marking rituals.

Remember this: The first instrument was the human body; the oldest surviving one is a 40,000-year-old flute.

Next: If music is that old, could it be older than language itself?

MUS-00.02 Is music older than language?

Short answer: Nobody knows for sure. Charles Darwin suggested that a "musical protolanguage" came before speech, and some researchers agree. Others think music grew out of language. Both use pitch, rhythm and emotion, and they share brain networks.

Keywords: music and language evolution, musical protolanguage, Darwin music, why humans make music

Darwin's guess

In *The Descent of Man* (1871), Darwin proposed that our ancestors sang before they spoke, using song in courtship. The archaeologist **Steven Mithen** (*The Singing Neanderthals*, 2005) argued for a shared "Hmmmmm" stage, holistic, musical and emotional.

The other view

The psychologist **Steven Pinker** once called music "auditory cheesecake": a pleasant by-product of abilities evolved for other purposes. Many researchers disagree, pointing to music's role in bonding (singing together releases endorphins and synchronises groups).

What babies tell us

Parents all over the world speak to babies in a sing-song voice ("motherese"), and lullabies across cultures sound alike. A 2018 Harvard study (Mehr and colleagues) found that people could guess whether a song from an unfamiliar culture was a lullaby, a dance song or a healing song.

India's view

Indian tradition treats sound itself as sacred: **nada brahma**, "sound is the absolute". The Samaveda set Rigvedic verses to melody.

Remember this: Music and language are cousins; which came first is still an open question.

Next: India built the most detailed system linking music to time. Why does a raga change with the time of day?

MUS-00.03 Why does a raga change with the time of day?

Short answer: In Hindustani tradition, each raga is linked to a time (samay) and sometimes a season, because its mood is felt to match that hour: Bhairav at dawn, Yaman at evening, Malhar in the monsoon. The rule is a tradition of feeling, systematised by musicians and theorists such as V. N. Bhatkhande, not a law of physics.

Keywords: raga time theory, morning ragas, evening ragas, samay chakra, raga and seasons

What a raga is

A raga is more than a scale. It is a set of notes with rules of movement, important notes (vadi and samvadi), typical phrases (pakad) and a mood (rasa). The same seven notes can make hundreds of ragas.

The clock of ragas

Musicians sort ragas into eight three-hour **prahars** of the day and night. Ragas with komal (flat) re and dha, like **Bhairav** and **Todi**, are morning ragas; **Yaman** and **Puriya** belong to the evening; **Darbari Kanada** to late night. Bhatkhande noticed patterns in which notes are used at which hour.

Seasons too

Malhar ragas are sung in the rains (Tansen's Miyan ki Malhar is the most famous), **Basant** and **Bahar** in spring. Legends say Tansen's Deepak raga lit lamps; these are stories, not history.

Carnatic and other views

Carnatic music has no strict time theory, though some ragas such as Bhoopalam are linked to morning. Many modern musicians perform any raga at any time on stage or recordings, and listeners still feel the moods.

Remember this: A raga's time is about mood and tradition; it is a map for feelings, not a timetable.

Next: Why does a group of notes feel happy or sad at all?

MUS-00.04 Why do some notes sound happy and others sad?

Short answer: Partly nature and partly culture. Faster tempo, higher pitch and major scales often sound happy to Western-trained ears; slow tempo, low pitch and minor scales sound sad. But studies of listeners with little exposure to Western music show the major/minor link is learned, while tempo and loudness cues are more universal.

Keywords: why minor keys sound sad, music and emotion, major vs minor, rasa in music, emotional music

What the body hears

Sad speech is slow, low and soft; excited speech is fast, high and loud. Music copies these vocal cues, so even an unfamiliar tune can sound joyful or mournful.

Learned meanings

A 2016 study (McDermott and colleagues, *Nature*) with the Tsimane' people of Bolivia, who have little exposure to Western music, found they did not prefer consonant over dissonant chords as Western listeners do. This suggests preferences for "sweet" chords are partly learned.

India's answer: rasa and bhava

Indian theory links ragas to **rasas**: Darbari Kanada to gravity and karuna (compassion), Bhairavi to devotion, Desh to romance. A singer's **bhava** (feeling) and the lyric deepen the mood.

Mixed feelings

Sad music is often enjoyed. Researchers suggest it lets us feel emotion safely, gives comfort and connects us to others, an idea close to the Indian view that rasa is joyful even when the emotion is sorrow.

Remember this: Some musical emotions are universal (speed, loudness), others are learned (major and minor).

Next: For most of history, music vanished the moment it ended. How did it get trapped in a box?

MUS-00.05 How did music get trapped in a box?

Short answer: Through recording. Édouard-Léon Scott's phonautograph (1857) drew sound waves but could not play them back; **Thomas Edison's phonograph (1877)** recorded and replayed sound. Then came discs, radio, tape, vinyl, cassettes, CDs, MP3s and streaming.

Keywords: history of recorded music, first sound recording, phonograph, gramophone India, first Indian recording

From air to wax

Edison recorded "Mary Had a Little Lamb" on tinfoil in 1877. **Emile Berliner's gramophone** (1887) used flat discs that could be mass-produced, which won the format war.

India on record

The **Gramophone Company** made India's first commercial recordings in Calcutta in **1902**. **Gauhar Jaan** became India's first recording star, announcing "My name is Gauhar Jaan" at the end of her records. Later, **All India Radio** (named in 1936) brought music to millions, and film songs dominated sales.

Each format changed music

The three-minute 78 rpm disc shaped the length of popular songs. The LP (1948) allowed whole albums and long ragas. The cassette (1960s, booming in India in the 1980s with T-Series) made music cheap and local. The CD (1982), the MP3 (1990s) and streaming (Spotify 2008; JioSaavn and Gaana in India) made almost all music instantly available.

What we gained and lost

Recording preserved voices that would have vanished and let a village singer reach the world. It also made live, local music less central to daily life.

Remember this: Recording turned music from an event into an object, and then into a stream.

Next: Recording lets songs repeat endlessly. Why does a song get stuck in your head?

MUS-00.06 Why does a song get stuck in your head?

Short answer: It is called an **earworm** (involuntary musical imagery). Songs with simple, repetitive melodies, a slightly unexpected interval and a fast tempo stick best. They pop up when the mind is idle or stressed, and usually fade by themselves.

Keywords: earworm, why songs get stuck in your head, catchy songs science, how to stop an earworm

What happens

Your brain replays a short loop, often just the chorus. Research led by **Kelly Jakubowski** (2016) found that earworm songs tend to have common melodic shapes with a few surprising leaps, like many hits.

Why the brain does it

Repetition is how memory works; music is built on repetition. Unfinished loops may nag the mind (the "Zeigarnik effect" is often suggested).

How to get rid of one

Listening to the whole song, chewing gum, or doing a moderately hard puzzle can help. Or simply wait.

Catchy by design

Advertising jingles, film songs and pop choruses are designed to be catchy. In India, a "hook line" in a film song can become a national catchphrase within days.

Remember this: Earworms are a side effect of a brain that loves patterns and repetition.

Next: Catchy songs now travel the whole planet at once. How does the world share one pop chart?

MUS-00.07 How does the world share one pop chart now?

Short answer: Streaming platforms and social media let a song spread across countries in days. Charts such as Billboard's Global 200 (2020) and Spotify's global charts measure this. Songs in Korean, Spanish, Punjabi and other languages now top global lists, not just English.

Keywords: global music charts, K-pop global success, Despacito, Punjabi music global, streaming and music

From national to global

Charts began with sheet music and record sales (*Billboard*, USA, from 1940; UK charts from 1952). Each country had its own. Streaming made listening data global and instant.

The new world hits

Luis Fonsi and Daddy Yankee's "Despacito" (2017) became one of the most viewed videos on YouTube. **BTS** and **BLACKPINK** made K-pop a global force. **Bad Bunny** became one of the world's most streamed artists singing in

Spanish, and his album won the Grammy for Album of the Year in 2026. Punjabi artists such as **Diljit Dosanjh** and **AP Dhillon** filled arenas abroad.

India's place

India is one of the world's largest music-streaming markets by users. Film songs still lead, but independent artists and regional music are growing.

The cost

Streaming pays artists fractions of a cent per play, and algorithms can favour the already famous. These are live debates (MUS-21).

Remember this: The global chart is new; the human love of a shared song is ancient.

Next: If algorithms pick songs, can AI also make music that moves us?

MUS-00.08 Can AI make music that moves us?

Short answer: AI can now generate songs that many listeners cannot tell from human ones. Whether they move us depends partly on the listener, and partly on knowing a human meant something. AI music also raises big questions about training on artists' work without permission and fair pay.

Keywords: AI music, can AI write songs, AI generated music copyright, future of music

Machines and music: an old story

Mozart's "musical dice game" generated minuets by chance. In 1957 the **Illiac Suite** was composed by a computer at the University of Illinois. Today, AI tools can produce full songs from a text prompt.

The worries

Record labels and artists have sued AI companies over training on copyrighted recordings (from 2024). Voice-cloning can imitate a singer without consent. Platforms now debate labelling AI tracks.

The promise

AI can help a beginner compose, restore old recordings, separate instruments in a mix (used to rescue the Beatles' "Now and Then", released 2023) and translate songs into other languages.

What music still needs

Music is also a relationship: a performer and a listener, a community at a concert, a singer whose life we know. Curious Sparoows labels any AI-assisted work openly.

Remember this: AI can make sounds; meaning still comes from the people who make and share them.

Next: Let's put the whole story together.

MUS-00.09 Recap: the story of music in one page

Short answer: Music began with voices and bodies, became sacred and systematic in ancient India, China and Greece, grew into great classical traditions, was captured by recording, spread by radio and streaming, and is now being reshaped by AI. Its power comes from rhythm, melody and the human need to feel together.

Keywords: history of music summary, music explained, story of music

1. **Body and voice** (forever): song, clapping, dance.
2. **First instruments** (about 40,000 years ago): bone flutes.
3. **Ancient systems**: Samaveda chant (India), Chinese pitch pipes, Greek modes, the *Natyashastra*'s music chapters.
4. **Classical traditions**: Hindustani and Carnatic, maqam, Western classical, gamelan, gagaku.
5. **Recording** (1877 onward): phonograph, gramophone (India 1902), radio (AIR 1936).

6. **Popular music explosion** (20th century): jazz, film song, rock, pop, hip-hop.
7. **Digital** (1980s onward): CD, MP3, streaming.
8. **AI** (2020s): new tools and new questions.

Remember this: Every song you love joins a chain of human voices going back 40,000 years.

Next: Start exploring the music of the world in Part 1, beginning with India.

PART 1 — MUSIC OF THE WORLD

About this Part. The first great classification is where music comes from. It begins with India in depth (classical, semi-classical, devotional, folk by region, film and independent music), then travels continent by continent. Each tradition has an identity card (what it is, where, key forms and instruments, legends) and, where useful, a **Music Register** of landmark recordings, compositions or albums. **Registers are a curated landmark selection, not a complete list** (see MUS-07.3). Every instrument named links to the Musical Instruments index (INS); film songs link to Movies (MOV).

Register fields. Year · Title · Artist / composer · Genre or form · Awards and reception · Why it matters. Sales and stream counts are given only with a source and date. A dash (—) means not recorded here, never a guess.

MUS-01 Indian classical music: two great systems

Before you start — MUS-01. Indian classical music is built on **raga** (melodic framework) and **tala** (rhythmic cycle), and is largely improvised within strict rules. From about the 13th century it developed into two systems: **Hindustani** (North) and **Carnatic** (South). Both trace their roots to the Samaveda, Bharata's *Natyashastra* and Sharngadeva's *Sangita Ratnakara* (13th century). **See also:** MUS-11 Raga and thaat, MUS-12 Tala, INS-01 Indian instruments.

☐ MUS-01.1 Hindustani classical music

The classical music of North India, Pakistan, Bangladesh and Nepal, shaped by court patronage under Sultanate and Mughal rulers and by Persian influence. **Tags:** #hindustani #classical #india

- ☐ **Dhrupad**: the oldest surviving form; austere, meditative, sung with the pakhawaj; four "banis" (Gauhar, Dagar, Khandar, Nauhar); the Dagar family and the Gundecha Brothers.
- ☐ **Khayal**: the main vocal form today, more flexible and ornamented, with slow (vilambit) and fast (drut) bandishes; developed by Sadarang and Adarang in the 18th century.
- ☐ **Tarana**: fast composition of meaningless syllables (ta, na, dere), credited by tradition to Amir Khusrau.
- ☐ **Instrumental music**: sitar, sarod, sarangi, bansuri, shehnai, santoor, violin, rudra veena; the alap–jor–jhala–gat structure.
- ☐ **Concert structure**: alap (unmetred exploration), then composition with tabla, improvisation (taans, bol-baant), climax.
- ☐ **Gharanas of khayal**: Gwalior (the oldest), Agra, Jaipur-Atrauli (Alladiya Khan), Kirana (Abdul Karim Khan, Bhimsen Joshi), Patiala (Bade Ghulam Ali Khan), Rampur-Sahaswan, Bhendibazaar, Mewati (Pandit Jasraj), Indore (Amir Khan).
- ☐ **Instrumental gharanas**: Maihar (Allauddin Khan; pupils Ravi Shankar, Ali Akbar Khan, Annapurna Devi, Nikhil Banerjee, Pannalal Ghosh), Senia, Imdadkhani (Vilayat Khan); tabla gharanas of Delhi, Ajrara, Lucknow, Farrukhabad, Benares, Punjab.
- ☐ **Legends**: Tansen (16th century, Akbar's court), Vishnu Narayan Bhatkhande and Vishnu Digambar Paluskar (20th-century reformers), Bade Ghulam Ali Khan, Kesarbai Kerkar, Gangubai Hangal, Kumar Gandharva, Kishori Amonkar, Bhimsen Joshi (Bharat Ratna 2009), Pandit Jasraj, Girija Devi, Parveen Sultana, Ravi Shankar (Bharat Ratna 1999), Ali Akbar Khan, Bismillah Khan (shehnai; Bharat Ratna 2001), Hariprasad Chaurasia, Shivkumar Sharma, Zakir Hussain (tabla, 1951–2024), Amjad Ali Khan, Rashid Khan, Kaushiki Chakraborty.

☐ MUS-01.2 Carnatic classical music

The classical music of South India (Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Kerala), centred on composed songs (kritis) and devotional lyrics. **Tags:** #carnatic #classical #south-india

- ☐ **Purandara Dasa** (1484–1564): "father of Carnatic music", who set the graded teaching lessons (sarali varisai, alankaras) still used today.
- ☐ **The Trinity** (18th–19th centuries, all born in Thiruvarur): **Tyagaraja** (Telugu kritis; the Pancharatna kritis sung every year at the Thiruvaiyaru Aradhana), **Muthuswami Dikshitar** (Sanskrit kritis) and **Syama Sastri**.
- ☐ **Other composers**: Swathi Thirunal, Annamacharya, Gopalakrishna Bharathi, Papanasam Sivan, Mysore Vasudevachar, Oothukkadu Venkata Kavi.

☐ **Forms**: varnam (concert opener), kriti (main song: pallavi, anupallavi, charanam), ragam–tanam–pallavi (the improvised centrepiece), javali, tillana, padam.

☐ **Concert (kutcheri)**: vocalist with violin, mridangam, ghatam, kanjira, morsing; the tani avartanam (percussion solo).

☐ **Melakarta system**: 72 parent scales (Venkatamakhin, 17th century; MUS-11.3).

☐ **Legends**: Ariyakudi Ramanuja Iyengar (concert format), G. N. Balasubramaniam, M. S. Subbulakshmi (first musician to receive the Bharat Ratna, 1998; sang at the United Nations, 1966), M. L. Vasanthakumari, D. K. Pattammal, Semmangudi Srinivasa Iyer, M. Balamuralikrishna, Lalgudi Jayaraman (violin), T. N. Krishnan, U. Srinivas (mandolin), K. J. Yesudas, Bombay Jayashri, T. M. Krishna, Sanjay Subrahmanyan.

☐ MUS-01.3 Comparing the two systems

☐ **Same roots, different growth**: both use raga and tala; Hindustani stresses long improvised alap, Carnatic stresses composed kritis and gamaka (oscillating ornaments).

☐ **Scales**: Hindustani uses Bhatkhande's ten thaats; Carnatic uses 72 melakartas.

☐ **Some shared ragas** with different names: Yaman (Hindustani) ≈ Kalyani (Carnatic); Bhairavi differs between the two.

☐ **Jugalbandi**: duets between the systems (for example, Hariprasad Chaurasia with Carnatic musicians).

MUS-02 Semi-classical, devotional and folk music of India

Before you start — MUS-02. Between classical concert music and everyday song lies a vast world: light classical forms, devotional music of every faith, and folk music of every region. This is where most Indians first meet music. **See also:** BOK-06.4 (ghazal as poetry), INS-01.

☐ MUS-02.1 Semi-classical and light classical

☐ **Thumri**: romantic, expressive songs of Lucknow and Benares, often about Krishna; Begum Akhtar, Siddheshwari Devi, Girija Devi ("Queen of Thumri"), Shobha Gurtu.

☐ **Dadra, kajri, chaiti, hori, jhoola**: seasonal and lighter forms of the Purab (eastern) tradition.

☐ **Tappa**: quick, zigzag phrases from Punjabi camel-drivers' songs; Shori Miyan.

☐ **Ghazal**: Urdu love poetry sung; Begum Akhtar, Mehdi Hassan, Ghulam Ali, Jagjit Singh, Pankaj Udhas, Talat Aziz, Iqbal Bano, Farida Khanum.

☐ **Natya sangeet**: Marathi stage songs (Bal Gandharva).

☐ **Rabindrasangeet and Nazrulgeeti**: Bengali song traditions of Tagore (over 2,000 songs) and Kazi Nazrul Islam.

☐ MUS-02.2 Devotional music

☐ **Vedic chanting**: Samaveda melodies; UNESCO Intangible Heritage (2008).

☐ **Bhajan and kirtan**: Hindu devotional songs; Meera, Surdas, Tulsidas, Kabir; Purushottam Das Jalota, Anup Jalota, Hari Om Sharan; Chaitanya's sankirtan in Bengal; Haridasa in Karnataka.

☐ **Abhang**: Marathi Varkari songs of Tukaram and Namdev; Pandit Bhimsen Joshi's "Santavani".

☐ **Gurbani kirtan**: singing of the Guru Granth Sahib in prescribed ragas; the ragis of the Golden Temple.

☐ **Qawwali**: Sufi devotional song with harmonium, tabla and chorus; founded by tradition by Amir Khusrau; Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan, the Sabri Brothers, Aziz Mian, Abida Parveen (kafi), Warsi Brothers.

☐ **Sufi music of Rajasthan and Punjab**; **Baul** of Bengal (UNESCO Intangible Heritage 2008; Purna Das Baul, Parvathy Baul).

☐ **Christian hymns and carols** of Goa, Kerala and the North-east; **Buddhist chants** of Ladakh (UNESCO 2012); **Jain stavans**.

☐ **Temple music**: nadaswaram and thavil of South India, Sopana sangeetham of Kerala, Haveli sangeet of Pushtimarg.

☐ MUS-02.3 Folk music by region

☐ **Rajasthan**: Manganiyar and Langa hereditary musicians (kamaicha, sarangi, khartal); Kalbelia songs (UNESCO 2010); Maand (Allah Jilai Bai, "Kesariya Balam"); Pabuji ki phad; Bhopa songs.

☐ **Punjab**: bhangra and giddha songs, boliyan, Heer singing, dhol; the roots of bhangra pop.

☐ **Gujarat**: garba and dandiya raas songs (Garba of Gujarat, UNESCO 2023), dayro.

☐ **Uttar Pradesh and Bihar**: birha, kajri, chaiti, Alha, sohar, Bhojpuri folk (Sharda Sinha, "Bihar Kokila", 1952–2024).

☐ **Bengal and Odisha**: Baul, Bhatiyali (boatmen's songs), Bhawaiya, Gambhira; Odissi music.

☐ **Maharashtra**: lavani, powada (ballads), bharud, koli songs.

☐ **Karnataka**: Bhavageete (light poetry songs), Janapada geete, Yakshagana music.

☐ **Tamil Nadu and Kerala**: gaana (Chennai street music), villu paatu (bow song), oppari (laments), Mappila pattu, Sopana, vadakkan pattu.

☐ **Andhra Pradesh and Telangana**: Burrakatha, Oggu Katha, folk songs of Bathukamma.

☐ **North-east**: Bihu songs (Assam), Naga and Mizo choral and folk song, Manipuri Nat Sankirtana (UNESCO 2013), Khasi songs.

☐ **Himalaya**: Pahari songs of Himachal, Garhwal and Kumaon, Kashmiri chhakri and Sufiana kalam.

☐ **Central India and tribal music**: Gond, Baiga, Bhil, Santal and Munda songs and dances; Pandavani (Teejan Bai, Chhattisgarh).

MUS-03 Film, popular and independent music of India

Before you start — MUS-03. For most of the 20th century, film songs were India's popular music, sung by "playback singers" while actors mimed. Each film industry has its own music. Since the 1990s, Indipop, independent bands, fusion, hip-hop and regional pop have grown, and streaming has opened new paths. **See also:** MOV-01 Indian cinema, MOV-14.5 Composers and singers.

☐ MUS-03.1 Hindi film music

☐ **Early talkies** (1931–1940s): *Alam Ara*'s "De De Khuda Ke Naam Par" (W. M. Khan, 1931), the first film song; K. L. Saigal, the first superstar singer; New Theatres (R. C. Boral, Pankaj Mullick).

☐ **Playback begins**: *Dhoop Chhaon* (1935), music by R. C. Boral, is often credited with the first playback songs.

☐ **Golden age** (1940s–1960s): composers Naushad, S. D. Burman, Shankar–Jaikishan, C. Ramchandra, Madan Mohan, O. P. Nayyar, Roshan, Salil Chowdhury, Hemant Kumar; singers Lata Mangeshkar, Mohammed Rafi, Asha Bhosle, Kishore Kumar, Mukesh, Manna Dey, Geeta Dutt, Talat Mahmood; lyricists Sahir Ludhianvi, Shailendra, Majrooh Sultanpuri, Kaifi Azmi, Shakeel Badayuni.

☐ **R. D. Burman era** (1970s–80s): rock, jazz and Latin sounds; Laxmikant–Pyarelal, Kalyanji–Anandji, Bappi Lahiri (disco).

☐ **1990s revival**: Nadeem–Shravan, Jatin–Lalit, Anu Malik; A. R. Rahman's arrival in Hindi (*Roja* dubbed, 1993; *Rangeela*, 1995); Kumar Sanu, Udit Narayan, Alka Yagnik, Kavita Krishnamurthy.

☐ **2000s–today**: Shankar–Ehsaan–Loy, Vishal–Shekhar, Pritam, Amit Trivedi, Sachin–Jigar; Sonu Nigam, Shreya Ghoshal, Sunidhi Chauhan, Arijit Singh, Shilpa Rao; lyricists Gulzar, Javed Akhtar, Prasoon Joshi, Irshad Kamil, Amitabh Bhattacharya.

☐ **Global moments**: A. R. Rahman's two Oscars for *Slumdog Millionaire* (2009); M. M. Keeravani and Chandrabose's Oscar for "Naatu Naatu" from the Telugu film *RRR* (2023).

☐ MUS-03.2 Film music of other Indian industries

☐ **Tamil**: G. Ramanathan, M. S. Viswanathan–T. K. Ramamoorthy, **Ilaiyaraaja** (over 1,000 films, symphonic and folk fusion), A. R. Rahman, Harris Jayaraj, Yuvan Shankar Raja, Anirudh Ravichander; singers T. M. Soundararajan, P. Susheela, S. P. Balasubrahmanyam (Guinness-cited for a huge number of songs), K. S. Chithra, S. Janaki.

☐ **Telugu**: Ghantasala, K. V. Mahadevan, M. M. Keeravani, Devi Sri Prasad, Thaman S.

☐ **Malayalam**: G. Devarajan, Salil Chowdhury, Johnson, Raveendran, Vidyasagar; K. J. Yesudas, K. S. Chithra.

☐ **Kannada**: G. K. Venkatesh, Vijaya Bhaskar, Hamsalekha; P. B. Sreenivas, Rajkumar (actor-singer).

☐ **Bengali**: Hemanta Mukherjee, Salil Chowdhury, Satyajit Ray (scored his own films), Manna Dey.

☐ **Marathi, Punjabi, Bhojpuri, Gujarati, Assamese (Bhupen Hazarika)** and others.

☐ MUS-03.3 Indipop, independent and new Indian music

☐ **Indipop** (1990s): Alisha Chinai (*Made in India*, 1995), Lucky Ali, Daler Mehndi ("Bolo Ta Ra Ra", 1995), Shaan, Euphoria, Colonial Cousins; MTV and Channel V.

☐ **Fusion**: Shakti (John McLaughlin, Zakir Hussain, L. Shankar; *This Moment* won a Grammy in 2024), Indian Ocean, Karsh Kale, Raghu Dixit, Coke Studio (Pakistan from 2008; India 2011–2015).

☐ **Rock and metal**: Parikrama, Indus Creed, Thermal and a Quarter, Bloodywood.

☐ **Hip-hop and rap**: Baba Sehgal (early 1990s), Bohemia, Yo Yo Honey Singh, Badshah, Divine and Naezy (Mumbai street rap, inspiring *Gully Boy*, 2019), Raftaar, Seedhe Maut, Hanumankind ("Big Dawgs", 2024).

☐ **Punjabi pop**: Gurdas Maan, Sidhu Moose Wala (1993–2022), Diljit Dosanjh (first Punjabi act at Coachella, 2023), AP Dhillon, Karan Aujla.

☐ **Independent singer-songwriters and pop**: Prateek Kuhad, Anuv Jain, Ritviz (electronic), Nucleya (bass), Lifafa, When Chai Met Toast.

☐ **Devotional and regional pop on streaming**: Haryanvi, Bhojpuri and Punjabi hits often lead YouTube views in India.

Music Register — India (landmark selection)

Year	Title	Artist / composer	Genre or form	Awards and reception	Why it matters
1902	First commercial recordings (Calcutta)	Gauhar Jaan and others; Gramophone Company	Khayal, thumri, dadra	—	Start of India's recorded music
1931	"De De Khuda Ke Naam Par" (*Alam Ara*)	W. M. Khan	Film song	—	First Indian film song
1949	"Aayega Aanewala" (*Mahal*)	Lata Mangeshkar; Khemchand Prakash	Film song	—	Made Lata a star
1955	*Music of India* (LP, Morning and Evening Ragas)	Ali Akbar Khan (introduced by Yehudi Menuhin)	Hindustani	—	First Indian classical LP made in the USA
1966	Recital at the United Nations	M. S. Subbulakshmi	Carnatic	—	Carnatic music on the world stage
1967	*West Meets East*	Ravi Shankar and Yehudi Menuhin	Classical fusion	Grammy 1967	First Grammy for an Indian musician
1971	*The Concert for Bangladesh*	Ravi Shankar, George Harrison and others	Benefit concert	Grammy (Album of the Year, 1973)	First great charity rock concert
1975	*Sholay* soundtrack	R. D. Burman	Film score	—	Songs and dialogue sold as records
1981	*Ek Duuje Ke Liye*	Laxmikant–Pyarelal; S. P. Balasubrahmanyam	Film	National Award (SPB)	Southern voice in Hindi cinema
1992	*Roja*	A. R. Rahman	Film score (Tamil)	National Award	New sound of Indian film music
1995	*Made in India*	Alisha Chinai, Biddu	Indipop	Best-selling Indipop album	Launch of Indian pop
2001	*Lagaan*	A. R. Rahman	Film score	National Award	Film nominated for an Oscar
2008	*Slumdog Millionaire* ("Jai Ho")	A. R. Rahman, Gulzar	Film score	Two Oscars (2009), Grammys (2010)	First Oscars for an Indian composer
2019	*Gully Boy*	Divine, Naezy and others	Hip-hop	Filmfare awards	Indian rap goes mainstream
2022	"Naatu Naatu" (*RRR*)	M. M. Keeravani, Chandrabose; sung by Rahul Sipligunj and Kaala Bhairava	Film song (Telugu)	Oscar and Golden Globe, 2023	First Oscar for an Indian-film song
2023	*This Moment*	Shakti (Zakir Hussain, Shankar Mahadevan and others)	Fusion	Grammy 2024	India's biggest Grammy night

MUS-04 Music of Asia and the Middle East

Before you start — MUS-04. Asia holds great classical systems built on melodic modes (maqam, dastgah, makam),

ensemble traditions (gamelan, gagaku) and huge modern pop industries (K-pop, J-pop, C-pop). **See also:** INS-02 Asian instruments.

☐ MUS-04.1 Arabic, Persian and Turkish traditions

- ☐ **Arabic maqam**: a system of melodic modes with microtones (quarter tones), improvised taqsim; Umm Kulthum (Egypt, "the Star of the East"), Mohammed Abdel Wahab, Fairuz (Lebanon), Abdel Halim Hafez; Iraqi maqam (UNESCO 2008).
- ☐ **Persian dastgah**: seven main modal systems and the radif repertoire; the tar, setar, santur and kamancheh; Mohammad-Reza Shajarian.
- ☐ **Turkish makam**: Ottoman court music, Mevlevi Sufi music (the whirling ceremony, UNESCO 2008), ney flute.
- ☐ **Modern pop**: Arabic pop (Amr Diab), Turkish pop (Tarkan), Persian diaspora pop (Googoosh).

☐ MUS-04.2 South and Central Asia beyond India

- ☐ **Pakistan**: qawwali (Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan, Abida Parveen), ghazal (Mehdi Hassan, Noor Jehan), Coke Studio Pakistan ("Pasoori", 2022), rock (Junoon).
- ☐ **Bangladesh and Nepal**: Baul and Lalon songs; Nepali folk (dohori) and modern songs (Narayan Gopal).
- ☐ **Sri Lanka**: baila, Kandyan drumming.
- ☐ **Afghanistan and Central Asia**: rubab music (Ustad Mohammad Omar); Uzbek and Tajik shashmaqam (UNESCO 2008); Mongolian throat singing (khöömei) and long song.

☐ MUS-04.3 East Asia

- ☐ **China**: ancient pitch-pipe theory and the pentatonic scale; the guqin (UNESCO 2008), pipa, erhu; Peking opera (UNESCO 2010); C-pop and Mandopop (Teresa Teng, Jay Chou).
- ☐ **Japan**: gagaku (imperial court music, among the oldest orchestral music still performed), shakuhachi, koto, shamisen, noh and kabuki music; enka (sentimental ballads); J-pop and city pop; anime and video-game music (Joe Hisaishi, Koji Kondo).
- ☐ **Korea**: pansori (epic storytelling song, UNESCO 2008), sanjo, samulnori percussion; **K-pop** (from Seo Taiji and Boys, 1992, to BTS, BLACKPINK, Stray Kids, the training-idol system).

☐ MUS-04.4 South-East Asia

- ☐ **Indonesia**: **gamelan** ensembles of Java and Bali (tuned bronze gongs and metallophones; UNESCO 2021), kecak, dangdut (Rhoma Irama).
- ☐ **Thailand, Cambodia, Laos, Myanmar**: piphat ensembles, khmer pinpeat, Lao khaen (mouth organ, UNESCO 2017), Myanmar saing waing.
- ☐ **Vietnam**: ca trù (UNESCO 2009), quan họ songs, đàn bầu.
- ☐ **Philippines**: kulintang gong music, OPM (Original Pilipino Music).

MUS-05 Music of Europe

Before you start — MUS-05. Europe gave the world the Western art-music tradition (MUS-08.1), staff notation and the symphony orchestra, plus rich folk traditions. **See also:** MUS-14 Timeline.

☐ MUS-05.1 European folk and regional traditions

- ☐ **Celtic** (Ireland, Scotland, Brittany, Galicia): fiddle, uilleann pipes, bagpipes, sean-nós singing.
- ☐ **Flamenco** (Andalusia, Spain; UNESCO 2010): song (cante), guitar (toque), dance (baile); Roma roots; Paco de Lucía, Camarón.
- ☐ **Fado** (Portugal; UNESCO 2011): songs of longing (saudade); Amália Rodrigues.
- ☐ **Balkan and Roma music**: brass bands, odd metres (7/8, 9/8), Bulgarian women's choirs.
- ☐ **Nordic**: joik of the Sámi people, Norwegian Hardanger fiddle.

☐ **Russian and Slavic**: folk choirs, balalaika, Orthodox chant.

☐ **Polyphonic singing** of Georgia (UNESCO 2008) and Corsica.

☐ **Chanson** (France): Édith Piaf, Jacques Brel; **canzone** (Italy); **Schlager** (Germany).

☐ MUS-05.2 European popular music

☐ **British Invasion**: The Beatles, The Rolling Stones, The Who; **Britpop**: Oasis, Blur; UK punk, new wave, grime (Stormzy), drum and bass.

☐ **Eurovision Song Contest** (1956): ABBA (Sweden, 1974), Céline Dion (for Switzerland, 1988), Måneskin (Italy, 2021).

☐ **European electronic music**: Kraftwerk (Germany), Daft Punk (France), Berlin techno, Ibiza house.

MUS-06 Music of the Americas

Before you start — MUS-06. The Americas mixed Indigenous, African and European music into many of the world's most influential popular genres: blues, jazz, country, rock and roll, soul, hip-hop, samba, salsa, reggae. **See also:** MUS-09 Popular genres.

☐ MUS-06.1 North America

☐ **Indigenous music**: pow-wow drums and songs, Inuit throat singing (katajjaq).

☐ **African American roots**: spirituals, work songs, ragtime (Scott Joplin), blues, gospel, jazz; the source of most American popular music.

☐ **Country and folk**: Appalachian ballads, bluegrass (Bill Monroe), the Grand Ole Opry (1925), Johnny Cash, Dolly Parton; folk revival (Woody Guthrie, Pete Seeger, Bob Dylan, Joan Baez).

☐ **Rock and roll and pop**: Elvis Presley, Chuck Berry, Little Richard; Motown (1959); Michael Jackson (*Thriller*, 1982); Madonna, Beyoncé, Taylor Swift.

☐ **Hip-hop**: born in the Bronx, New York, in 1973 (DJ Kool Herc's party); Grandmaster Flash, Run-DMC, Tupac, Notorious B.I.G., Jay-Z, Eminem, Kendrick Lamar (Pulitzer Prize for Music 2018, the first for a non-classical, non-jazz work).

☐ **Canada**: Joni Mitchell, Leonard Cohen, Céline Dion, Drake, The Weeknd.

☐ MUS-06.2 Latin America

☐ **Mexico**: mariachi (UNESCO 2011), ranchera, son jarocho, norteño and corridos.

☐ **Cuba and the Caribbean**: son cubano, rumba, mambo, cha-cha-chá, salsa (developed in New York by Cuban and Puerto Rican musicians), Buena Vista Social Club (1997).

☐ **Brazil**: samba (UNESCO 2005, samba de roda), bossa nova (João Gilberto, Antônio Carlos Jobim, "The Girl from Ipanema", 1962), MPB, Tropicália (Caetano Veloso, Gilberto Gil), funk carioca.

☐ **Argentina and Uruguay**: tango (UNESCO 2009; Carlos Gardel, Astor Piazzolla's nuevo tango).

☐ **Andes**: huayno, panpipes (siku) and charango; Colombian cumbia and vallenato; Dominican merengue and bachata.

☐ **Reggaeton and Latin pop**: Puerto Rico and Panama (Daddy Yankee, Bad Bunny), Shakira, Karol G.

☐ MUS-06.3 The Caribbean

☐ **Jamaica**: mento, ska, rocksteady, **reggae** (Bob Marley and the Wailers; UNESCO 2018), dub (sound-system culture), dancehall.

☐ **Trinidad and Tobago**: calypso, soca, the steelpan (invented in the 20th century from oil drums); chutney music of Indo-Trinidadians (Sundar Popo), blending Bhojpuri folk song with soca.

☐ **Haiti and the French Caribbean**: kompa, zouk.

MUS-07 Music of Africa and Oceania

Before you start — MUS-07. African music is the root of much of the world's popular music through the Atlantic diaspora. It is known for polyrhythm, call-and-response and the close link of music, dance and speech (talking drums). **See also:** INS-04 African instruments.

☐ MUS-07.1 Africa

☐ **West Africa**: griot (jeli) praise singers with kora and balafon (Toumani Diabaté, Salif Keita); highlife (Ghana), **Afrobeat** (Fela Kuti, Nigeria, 1970s), **Afrobeats** (Burna Boy, Wizkid, Tems; Grammy category Best African Music Performance from 2024), mbalax (Youssou N'Dour), desert blues (Tinariwen, Ali Farka Touré).

☐ **Central Africa**: Congolese rumba and soukous (UNESCO 2021; Franco, Papa Wemba).

☐ **East Africa**: taarab (Zanzibar), benga (Kenya), Ethiopian modes and Ethio-jazz (Mulatu Astatke).

☐ **Southern Africa**: isicathamiya (Ladysmith Black Mambazo), mbube, mbaqanga, kwaito, **amapiano** (South Africa, 2010s); Miriam Makeba, Hugh Masekela.

☐ **North Africa**: Gnawa (Morocco, UNESCO 2019), raï (Algeria; Khaled), Andalusian music.

☐ MUS-07.2 Oceania

☐ **Aboriginal Australia**: songlines, the didgeridoo (yidaki) of Arnhem Land, clapsticks; Yothu Yindi, Gurrumul.

☐ **Māori music** (New Zealand): waiata (songs), haka (posture dance with chant).

☐ **Pacific**: Polynesian choral singing, Hawaiian slack-key guitar and ukulele, Fijian meke.

☐ **Pop**: AC/DC, Kylie Minogue, Lorde, Sia.

Music Register — the world (landmark selection)

Year	Title	Artist / composer	Genre or form	Awards and reception	Why it matters
1741	*Messiah*	George Frideric Handel	Oratorio	—	Among the most performed choral works
1788	Symphony No. 40	Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart	Classical symphony	—	Classical-era perfection
1824	Symphony No. 9 ("Choral")	Ludwig van Beethoven	Romantic symphony	"Ode to Joy" is the anthem of Europe	Composed while deaf
1913	*The Rite of Spring*	Igor Stravinsky	Ballet score	Riot at the Paris premiere (legend exaggerated)	Rhythm breaks the rules
1928	"West End Blues"	Louis Armstrong	Jazz	Grammy Hall of Fame	Jazz solo as art
1956	"Heartbreak Hotel"	Elvis Presley	Rock and roll	Number 1, USA	Rock and roll goes national
1959	*Kind of Blue*	Miles Davis	Modal jazz	Best-selling jazz album	Modal jazz landmark
1964	Concerts of *Enta Omri*	Umm Kulthum, Mohammed Abdel Wahab	Arabic song	—	The voice of the Arab world
1967	*Sgt. Pepper's Lonely Hearts Club Band*	The Beatles	Rock	Grammy Album of the Year 1968	The album as an art form; sitar on "Within You Without You"
1973	*The Dark Side of the Moon*	Pink Floyd	Progressive rock	Among the best-selling albums	Concept album and studio craft
1977	*Exodus*	Bob Marley and the Wailers	Reggae	*Time*'s album of the century (1999)	Reggae worldwide
1979	"Rapper's Delight"	The Sugarhill Gang	Hip-hop	—	First hip-hop chart hit
1982	*Thriller*	Michael Jackson	Pop	8 Grammys (1984); often cited as the best-selling album ever	Music video era
1985	"We Are the World"	USA for Africa	Charity pop	Grammys	Global famine relief
1990s	Qawwali recordings with Peter Gabriel (*Mustt Mustt*, 1990)	Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan	Qawwali fusion	—	Sufi music to the world
2017	"Despacito"	Luis Fonsi, Daddy Yankee	Reggaeton / Latin pop	Among the most viewed YouTube videos	Spanish-language global hit
2020	"Dynamite"	BTS	K-pop	Billboard Hot 100 number 1	First all-Korean act to top the Hot 100
2025	*DeBÍ TiRAR MáS FOToS*	Bad Bunny	Latin / reggaeton	Grammy Album of the Year 2026	All-Spanish album wins the top Grammy

☐ MUS-07.3 How the registers grow

1. **Award lists first** (Grammy, Sangeet Natak Akademi, National Film Awards, Filmfare), because they are official and dated.
2. **Charts and certifications** (Billboard, Official Charts, IMI and IFPI), always with date and type of figure.
3. **Archives and discographies**: Archive of Indian Music, Smithsonian Folkways, British Library Sound Archive, Discogs (checked against labels).
4. **Expert lists with named sources** (*Rolling Stone*, *Gramophone*, Sangeet Natak Akademi documentation).
5. **Readers' suggestions**, checked before they are added.

PART 2 — GENRES AND STYLES

About this Part. The second great classification is what kind of music it is. Genres are families with shared sounds, instruments and purposes. They overlap and mix constantly, so treat this as a map, not a fence. Each genre has a one- or two-line definition, its roots and examples.

MUS-08 Art, classical, religious and folk music families

Before you start — MUS-08. "Classical" means different things in different places: Indian classical (MUS-01), Western classical, Arabic and Persian classical, Chinese and Japanese court music. All share long training, theory and a respected canon. **See also:** MUS-14 Timeline.

☐ MUS-08.1 Western classical music by period

☐ **Medieval** (about 500–1400): Gregorian chant, Hildegard of Bingen, early polyphony (Notre-Dame school).

☐ **Renaissance** (about 1400–1600): Josquin des Prez, Palestrina; the madrigal.

☐ **Baroque** (about 1600–1750): opera born in Florence (Peri, about 1597–1600) and Monteverdi; Vivaldi (*The Four Seasons*), J. S. Bach, Handel; the concerto and fugue.

☐ **Classical** (about 1750–1820): Haydn ("father of the symphony"), Mozart, early Beethoven; sonata form, string quartet.

☐ **Romantic** (about 1820–1910): Beethoven's late works, Schubert, Chopin, Liszt, Wagner, Verdi, Brahms, Tchaikovsky, Mahler; nationalism (Dvořák, Grieg, the Russian Five).

☐ **Modern and 20th century**: Debussy (impressionism), Stravinsky, Schoenberg (twelve-tone), Bartók, Shostakovich, Gershwin, Britten.

☐ **Contemporary**: minimalism (Steve Reich, Philip Glass, Arvo Pärt), film-influenced concert music, John Adams; Indian-Western fusions such as Philip Glass and Ravi Shankar's *Passages* (1990).

☐ **Opera, oratorio, symphony, concerto, chamber music, art song (Lied)**: the main forms.

☐ MUS-08.2 Religious and spiritual music

☐ Vedic chant, bhajan and kirtan, Gurbani, qawwali and Sufi music (MUS-02.2); Gregorian chant; Byzantine chant; Jewish cantillation; Islamic adhan and Qur'anic recitation (tajwid); Buddhist chant; gospel; Christian hymns; Shinto kagura.

☐ MUS-08.3 Folk and traditional music

☐ Music passed down orally in communities: work songs, ballads, wedding songs, laments, lullabies, dance music; collected by ethnomusicologists (Alan Lomax, Béla Bartók, Komal Kothari in Rajasthan). India's folk music is covered by region in MUS-02.3.

MUS-09 Popular genres of the world

Before you start — MUS-09. Most popular genres of the 20th century were born in the Americas from African, European and Indigenous roots, then spread worldwide and mixed with local music. Each has many sub-genres. **See also:** MUS-06 Americas, MUS-16 People.

☐ MUS-09.1 Blues

Twelve-bar form, "blue notes" and songs of hardship, born among African Americans in the Mississippi Delta around 1900. Robert Johnson, Bessie Smith, Muddy Waters (Chicago electric blues), B. B. King. **Sub-genres:** Delta, Chicago, Texas, electric, blues rock.

☐ MUS-09.2 Jazz

Improvisation, swing rhythm and "blue" harmony, born in New Orleans around 1900–1915. **Tags:** #jazz

☐ **New Orleans and Dixieland**: Louis Armstrong, Jelly Roll Morton.

☐ **Swing and big band** (1930s–40s): Duke Ellington, Count Basie, Benny Goodman, Ella Fitzgerald.

☐ **Bebop** (1940s): Charlie Parker, Dizzy Gillespie, Thelonious Monk.

☐ **Cool, hard bop and modal**: Miles Davis, John Coltrane (*A Love Supreme*, 1965, influenced by Indian music; he named his son Ravi).

☐ **Free jazz, fusion and Latin jazz**: Ornette Coleman, Weather Report, Chick Corea, Tito Puente.

☐ **Indo-jazz**: Joe Harriott and John Mayer's *Indo-Jazz Fusions* (1967), Shakti, Louiz Banks ("Godfather of Indian jazz"), Goa's jazz musicians in Bombay's film orchestras.

☐ MUS-09.3 Country and folk

Country grew from Appalachian and Southern rural music; folk from older ballad traditions. **Sub-genres:** bluegrass, honky-tonk, Nashville sound, outlaw country, country pop, Americana, folk rock, singer-songwriter.

☐ MUS-09.4 Rock

Electric guitars, bass and drums; born from rhythm and blues and country in the 1950s. **Tags:** #rock

☐ **Rock and roll** (1950s), **British Invasion** and **psychedelic rock** (1960s; The Beatles' Indian period, George Harrison studying sitar with Ravi Shankar), **hard rock** (Led Zeppelin), **progressive rock** (Pink Floyd, Yes), **glam**, **punk** (Ramones, Sex Pistols, 1970s), **new wave**, **heavy metal** (Black Sabbath, Iron Maiden, Metallica), **grunge** (Nirvana), **alternative and indie**, **Britpop**, **post-rock**.

☐ MUS-09.5 Pop

Catchy, song-centred music for wide audiences; the word comes from "popular". Tin Pan Alley, crooners (Frank Sinatra), teen pop, synth-pop, dance-pop, K-pop, J-pop, Bollywood pop, Latin pop, bubblegum, art pop, hyperpop.

☐ MUS-09.6 R&B, soul and funk

☐ **Rhythm and blues** (1940s): the Black popular music that led to rock and roll.

☐ **Soul** (1960s): gospel feeling in secular songs; Ray Charles, Aretha Franklin ("Queen of Soul"), Otis Redding, Motown (Stevie Wonder, Marvin Gaye) and Stax.

☐ **Funk** (late 1960s): James Brown, Parliament-Funkadelic; groove on the "one".

☐ **Disco** (1970s): Donna Summer, Bee Gees; Bappi Lahiri brought disco to Bollywood.

☐ **Contemporary R&B and neo-soul**: Whitney Houston, Mariah Carey, Erykah Badu, Beyoncé, Frank Ocean.

☐ MUS-09.7 Hip-hop and rap

Rhythmic speech (rapping) over beats, with DJing, breakdancing and graffiti as the four elements. Born in the Bronx in 1973. **Sub-genres:** old school, gangsta, conscious, trap, drill, grime (UK), boom bap, desi hip-hop and gully rap (India), K-hip-hop.

☐ MUS-09.8 Electronic and dance music

Music made mainly with electronic instruments and computers. **Tags:** #electronic

☐ **Pioneers**: musique concrète (Pierre Schaeffer, 1948), Karlheinz Stockhausen, the Moog synthesizer (1964), Kraftwerk.

☐ **Dance genres**: house (Chicago, 1980s), techno (Detroit), trance, drum and bass, dubstep, EDM, garage, psytrance (born in Goa's beach parties in the 1990s, "Goa trance"), amapiano.

☐ **Listening genres**: ambient (Brian Eno, *Music for Airports*, 1978), IDM, synthwave, lo-fi hip-hop.

☐ MUS-09.9 Reggae and Caribbean styles

Ska, rocksteady, reggae, dub, dancehall, calypso, soca, zouk, kompa, chutney (MUS-06.3).

☐ MUS-09.10 Latin music

Salsa, merengue, bachata, cumbia, tango, bossa nova, samba, mariachi, reggaeton, Latin trap, Latin rock (MUS-06.2).

☐ MUS-09.11 Metal and punk families

☐ **Metal**: heavy metal, thrash, death, black, doom, power, nu-metal, metalcore, folk metal (Bloodywood from India mixes metal with Punjabi folk).

☐ **Punk**: punk rock, hardcore, pop-punk, post-punk, emo.

☐ MUS-09.12 World music and fusion

"World music" was a marketing label invented by record companies in London in 1987 for music from outside the Anglo-American mainstream. Fusion examples: Shakti, Ravi Shankar with the Beatles, Nitin Sawhney, Anoushka Shankar, Paul Simon's *Graceland* (1986, South African musicians), Buena Vista Social Club.

☐ MUS-09.13 Music for screen, games and stage

☐ **Film scores**: Max Steiner, Bernard Herrmann, Ennio Morricone, John Williams (*Star Wars*), Hans Zimmer, A. R. Rahman, Ilaiyaraaja, Satyajit Ray; Indian film songs as a genre of their own (MUS-03).

☐ **Video-game music**: Koji Kondo (*Super Mario*), Nobuo Uematsu (*Final Fantasy*).

☐ **Musical theatre**: Broadway and West End (Rodgers and Hammerstein, Andrew Lloyd Webber, Lin-Manuel Miranda's *Hamilton*); A. R. Rahman's *Bombay Dreams* (2002).

☐ **Jingles and advertising music**: India's "Mile Sur Mera Tumhara" (1988) and ad jingles as public memory.

☐ MUS-09.14 Children's music and lullabies

Nursery rhymes, lullabies (lori), school songs, educational songs (Sesame Street, Indian rhymes channels on YouTube, among the most viewed in the world).

PART 3 — THE BUILDING BLOCKS OF MUSIC

About this Part. What music is made of, explained side by side in Indian and Western terms. This Part is the "grammar" every other Part uses.

MUS-10 Sound, pitch and the notes

Before you start — MUS-10. Sound is vibration travelling through air. Its **pitch** depends on frequency (vibrations per second, hertz), its **loudness** on amplitude, and its **timbre** (tone colour) on the mix of overtones. **See also:** TEC (acoustics, audio technology), INS-00 How instruments make sound.

☐ MUS-10.1 The physics of sound

☐ **Frequency and pitch**: concert A is tuned to 440 Hz in most Western music (an international standard since 1955, ISO 16); Indian music has no fixed pitch: the singer chooses the tonic (Sa).

☐ **Overtones and harmonics**: a plucked string vibrates at many frequencies at once; the tanpura's buzzing bridge (jawari) brings out its overtones.

☐ **Octave**: doubling of frequency; the octave sounds like "the same note, higher" in every culture.

☐ **Tuning systems**: just intonation (pure ratios), equal temperament (the piano's 12 equal semitones), the 22 shrutis of Indian theory.

☐ MUS-10.2 Notes: swara and solfège

☐ **Indian sargam**: Sa Re Ga Ma Pa Dha Ni (shadja, rishabha, gandhara, madhyama, panchama, dhaivata, nishada); Sa and Pa are fixed (achal), the others can be komal (flat) or tivra (sharp), giving 12 notes.

☐ **Western notes**: C D E F G A B (do re mi fa sol la ti), with sharps and flats making 12 semitones.

☐ **Saptak**: the Indian octave, in three registers: mandra (low), madhya (middle), taar (high).

☐ **Shruti**: the 22 micro-intervals described in the *Natyashastra*, used to explain fine pitch differences between ragas.

MUS-11 Scales, modes, raga and thaat

Before you start — MUS-11. A **scale** is a set of notes in order; a **mode** is a scale with a home note and character; a **raga** is a mode plus rules of movement, ornaments and mood. **See also:** MUS-01 Indian classical, MUS-00.03 Raga and time.

☐ MUS-11.1 Western scales and modes

☐ Major and minor scales; the church modes (Ionian, Dorian, Phrygian, Lydian, Mixolydian, Aeolian, Locrian); pentatonic scale (five notes; used worldwide from China to Scotland to Indian ragas like Bhupali); blues scale; chromatic scale; whole-tone scale.

☐ MUS-11.2 Raga

☐ **Aroha and avaroha**: ascending and descending note order.

☐ **Vadi and samvadi**: the most important and second most important notes.

☐ **Pakad / chalan**: characteristic phrases that identify a raga.

☐ **Jati**: number of notes: audav (5), shadav (6), sampurna (7).

☐ **Gamaka and meend**: ornaments and glides; Carnatic music uses many gamakas.

☐ **Rasa and samay**: mood and time (MUS-00.03).

☐ **Ragamala paintings**: ragas personified in Rajput and Mughal miniatures (16th–19th centuries).

☐ MUS-11.3 Classifying ragas: thaat and melakarta

☐ **Thaat** (Hindustani): V. N. Bhatkhande's ten parent scales: Bilawal, Kalyan, Khamaj, Bhairav, Poorvi, Marwa, Kafi, Asavari, Bhairavi, Todi.

☐ **Melakarta** (Carnatic): 72 parent scales, systematised by Venkatamakhin (*Chaturdandi Prakashika*, 17th century) and later Govindacharya; ragas derived from them are janya ragas.

☐ **Older systems**: grama and murchhana (*Natyashastra*), raga–ragini families (medieval).

Raga Register — twenty ragas to know (Hindustani, with Carnatic cousins)

Raga	Thaat	Time (samay)	Character of notes	Mood (rasa)	A famous example
Bhairav	Bhairav	Dawn	Komal re and dha	Devotion, gravity	"Jago Mohan Pyare" (*Jagte Raho*, 1956)
Ahir Bhairav	Bhairav	Early morning	Bhairav below, Kafi above	Tender devotion	"Poocho Na Kaise" (*Meri Surat Teri Ankhen*, 1963)
Todi (Miyan ki Todi)	Todi	Late morning	Komal re, ga, dha; tivra ma	Pathos, longing	Classical khayal recordings by many masters
Bilawal	Bilawal	Morning	All shuddha notes (like the major scale)	Calm joy	Basis of the Western major scale comparison
Bhupali	Kalyan	Evening	Pentatonic: Sa Re Ga Pa Dha	Peace, devotion	Carnatic cousin: Mohanam
Yaman	Kalyan	Early night	Tivra ma	Romance, serenity	"Chandan Sa Badan" (*Saraswatichandra*, 1968); Carnatic cousin: Kalyani
Bihag	Bilawal	Night	Both madhyamas	Romance	Late-night khayals and thumris
Kafi	Kafi	Night (often holi songs)	Komal ga and ni	Playful, folk-like	Holi thumris; Carnatic cousin: Kharaharapriya
Desh	Khamaj	Night; monsoon	Both nishads	Patriotism, romance, rain	Monsoon songs and many patriotic songs
Khamaj	Khamaj	Night	Komal ni in descent	Light, romantic	Many thumris and ghazals
Malkauns	Bhairavi	Late night	Pentatonic with komal ga, dha, ni	Deep, meditative	"Man Tadpat Hari Darshan Ko Aaj" (*Baiju Bawra*, 1952)
Darbari Kanada	Asavari	Midnight	Andolit (oscillating) komal ga and dha	Majesty, gravity	Associated by tradition with Tansen
Marwa	Marwa	Sunset	Komal re, tivra ma, no Pa	Restless twilight	—
Puriya Dhanashri	Poorvi	Sunset	Komal re and dha, tivra ma	Yearning	—
Basant	Poorvi	Spring; night	Both madhyamas	Spring joy	Seasonal raga
Miyan ki Malhar	Kafi	Monsoon	Both nishads, andolit komal ga	Rain, longing	Attributed by tradition to Tansen
Bhairavi	Bhairavi	Morning; concert closer	All komal notes (re, ga, dha, ni)	Devotion, farewell	"Babul Mora" (K. L. Saigal, *Street Singer*, 1938)
Hamsadhwani	Bilawal	Evening	Pentatonic: Sa Re Ga Pa Ni	Auspicious, bright	Carnatic origin; "Vatapi Ganapatim" (Dikshitar)
Shivaranjani	Kafi	Night	Pentatonic with komal ga	Sorrow, longing	"Mere Naina Sawan Bhadon" (*Mehbooba*, 1976)
Jaunpuri	Asavari	Late morning	Komal ga, dha, ni	Seriousness	Popular in khayal and film

☐ MUS-11.4 Modes of other traditions

☐ Arabic maqam (Rast, Bayati, Hijaz), Persian dastgah (Shur, Mahur), Turkish makam, Javanese slendro and pelog, Japanese in and yo scales.

MUS-12 Rhythm, tempo and tala

Before you start — MUS-12. Rhythm is how music is organised in time. Western music counts beats in bars (measures); Indian music uses **tala**, cycles that return to the first beat, **sam**. **See also:** INS-01.4 Indian percussion.

☐ MUS-12.1 Western rhythm

☐ Beat, tempo (bpm), metre (time signatures such as 4/4, 3/4 waltz, 6/8), syncopation, polyrhythm, swing, backbeat.

☐ **Tempo words**: largo (very slow), adagio, andante, moderato, allegro, presto (very fast).

☐ MUS-12.2 Hindustani tala

☐ **Elements**: matra (beat), vibhag (section), sam (first beat), khali (empty, "wave" beat), tali (clap), theka (basic drum pattern), laya (tempo: vilambit, madhya, drut), layakari (rhythmic play).

☐ **Common talas**: teentaal (16 beats), jhaptaal (10), ektaal (12), rupak (7, starting on khali), dadra (6), keherwa (8), chautaal (12, dhrupad), deepchandi (14).

☐ **Bols**: spoken drum syllables (dha, dhin, na, ti, te, ka) used to teach and recite rhythm.

Tala Register — common Hindustani talas

Tala	Beats (matras)	Divisions (vibhag)	Sam, tali and khali	Used for	Theka begins
Teentaal	16	4+4+4+4	X 2 0 3	Khayal, instrumental gat, kathak	Dha dhin dhin dha
Ektaal	12	2+2+2+2+2+2	X 0 2 0 3 4	Vilambit and drut khayal	Dhin dhin dhage tirakita
Jhaptaal	10	2+3+2+3	X 2 0 3	Khayal, bhajan	Dhi na dhi dhi na
Rupak	7	3+2+2	Starts on khali	Light classical, film	Ti ti na dhi na
Dadra	6	3+3	X 0	Dadra, ghazal, folk	Dha dhi na dha ti na
Keherwa	8	4+4	X 0	Folk, bhajan, film songs	Dha ge na ti na ke dhi na
Chautaal	12	2+2+2+2+2+2	X 0 2 0 3 4	Dhrupad (on pakhawaj)	Dha dha din ta
Dhamar	14	5+2+3+4	X 2 0 3	Dhrupad-style hori songs	Ka dhi ta dhi ta dha
Deepchandi	14	3+4+3+4	X 2 0 3	Thumri	Dha dhin – dha dha tin –
Jhoomra	14	3+4+3+4	X 2 0 3	Very slow khayal	Dhin –dha tirakita

☐ MUS-12.3 Carnatic tala

☐ **Suladi sapta tala**: seven talas (Dhruva, Matya, Rupaka, Jhampa, Triputa, Ata, Eka), each with five jatis, giving 35 talas.

☐ **Adi tala** (8 beats): the most used; **Rupaka**, **Misra Chapu** (7), **Khanda Chapu** (5).

☐ **Konnakol**: the vocal art of rhythm syllables (ta ka dhi mi).

☐ MUS-12.4 Rhythm around the world

☐ African polyrhythm and timeline patterns (the clave and bell patterns), Balkan aksak metres, Arabic iqa'at, gamelan colotomic cycles, Latin clave.

MUS-13 Melody, harmony, form and notation

Before you start — MUS-13. Melody is notes in a line; harmony is notes together; form is the plan of a piece; notation is how music is written. Indian music is mainly melodic, with harmony coming from the tanpura drone. **See also:** MUS-20 Composition.

☐ MUS-13.1 Melody and harmony

☐ **Melody**: contour, phrase, motif, range, hook.

☐ **Harmony**: intervals, chords (triads, sevenths), consonance and dissonance, chord progressions (the I–V–vi–IV "four chords" of pop), counterpoint (Bach), the drone (tanpura, bagpipes).

☐ **Texture**: monophony (one line), heterophony (one tune, varied together, common in Asian music), homophony (melody plus chords), polyphony (many independent lines).

☐ MUS-13.2 Form

☐ **Western forms**: binary, ternary, rondo, theme and variations, sonata form, fugue, verse–chorus, twelve-bar blues, 32-bar AABA song.

☐ **Indian forms**: alap–jor–jhala–gat; khayal's sthayi and antara; Carnatic kriti's pallavi, anupallavi, charanam; film song's mukhda (refrain) and antara (verse).

☐ MUS-13.3 Notation

☐ **Western staff notation**: developed from medieval neumes; Guido d'Arezzo (about 1025) gave lines and the "ut re mi" syllables.

☐ **Indian notation**: sargam letters; **Bhatkhande** and **Paluskar** notation systems (early 20th century); Carnatic notation from Subbarama Dikshitar's *Sangita Sampradaya Pradarshini* (1904).

☐ **Other notations**: Chinese gongche, guitar tablature, chord charts, MIDI and the piano roll in software.

☐ **Oral teaching (guru–shishya parampara)**: much Indian and world music is still learned by ear from a teacher.

PART 4 — HISTORY AND TIMELINE

About this Part. The story of music in order, with India and the world side by side, then the story of how technology changed listening. Ancient dates are scholarly estimates.

MUS-14 Timeline of music

Before you start — MUS-14. Music history is not one straight line: many traditions grew at the same time and influenced each other. **See also:** MUS-08.1 Western periods, MUS-01 Indian classical.

☐ MUS-14.1 Prehistory and the ancient world (to about 500 CE)

☐ **Bone flutes** (about 40,000 years ago, Germany); Bhimbetka rock art of dance (India).

☐ **Mesopotamia**: the lyres of Ur (about 2500 BCE); the Hurrian Hymn (about 1400 BCE), the oldest substantially surviving written melody.

☐ **India**: **Samaveda** (the Veda of melody); Gandharva music; Bharata's *__Natyashastra__* (about 200 BCE–200 CE) with chapters on music, instruments, shruti and rasa.

☐ **China**: bronze bells of Marquis Yi of Zeng (433 BCE), 65 tuned bells; music as part of Confucian ritual.

☐ **Greece**: Pythagoras and the mathematics of intervals; Greek modes; the Seikilos epitaph (about 1st century CE), the oldest complete surviving song.

☐ **Egypt**: harps, lutes and temple music.

☐ MUS-14.2 Medieval period (about 500–1400)

☐ **India**: Matanga's *Brihaddeshi* (about 9th century), the first text to use the word "raga" in its technical sense; Jayadeva's *Gita Govinda* (12th century, sung in temples); *__Sharngadeva's__* Sangita Ratnakara* **(13th century);** Amir Khusrau** (1253–1325) at the Delhi Sultanate court, credited by tradition with qawwali, tarana and other innovations (some attributions are legendary).

☐ **Islamic world**: al-Kindi and al-Farabi's *Great Book of Music* (10th century); Ziryab's music school in Córdoba.

☐ **Europe**: Gregorian chant, Guido d'Arezzo's notation (about 1025), troubadours, early polyphony.

☐ **East Asia**: Tang court music; gagaku comes to Japan.

☐ MUS-14.3 Early modern period (about 1400–1750)

☐ **India**: the bhakti song movement (Kabir, Meera, Surdas, Purandara Dasa); Raja Man Singh Tomar of Gwalior and dhrupad (15th century); **Tansen** at Akbar's court; the *Ain-i-Akbari* lists musicians of the court; Venkatamakhin's melakarta theory (17th century).

☐ **Europe**: printing of music (Ottaviano Petrucci, 1501); Renaissance polyphony; opera (about 1600); Baroque (Bach, Handel, Vivaldi).

☐ **Africa and the Americas**: the transatlantic slave trade carries African music to the Americas.

☐ MUS-14.4 The long 19th century (about 1750–1914)

☐ **India**: the Carnatic Trinity (Tyagaraja, Dikshitar, Syama Sastri); the rise of khayal and gharanas; Wajid Ali Shah's Lucknow and thumri; harmonium arrives (mid-19th century; banned on All India Radio from 1940 to 1971 as "foreign"); the first music schools (Gandharva Mahavidyalaya, Lahore, 1901, by Paluskar).

☐ **Europe**: Classical and Romantic eras; public concerts; the piano in middle-class homes.

☐ **Americas**: spirituals, ragtime, the birth of blues and jazz (about 1900).

☐ **Technology**: phonograph (1877), gramophone (1887), first recordings in India (1902).

☐ MUS-14.5 The 20th century (1914–1999)

☐ **India**: Bhatkhande's *Hindustani Sangeet Paddhati* and the thaat system; the All-India Music Conferences (from 1916, Baroda); Madras Music Academy (1928) and the December Season; **All India Radio** (1936) and its national programme of music; film songs dominate from 1931; **Ravi Shankar** takes Indian music to Monterey (1967) and Woodstock (1969); cassette boom (T-Series, 1980s); MTV India and Indipop (1990s).

☐ **World**: jazz age (1920s), swing (1930s), bebop (1940s), rock and roll (1950s), the Beatles and the 1960s counterculture, reggae and punk (1970s), hip-hop and MTV (1981), grunge and Britpop (1990s), K-pop (1992 onward).

☐ MUS-14.6 The 21st century (2000 onward)

☐ Napster (1999) and the MP3 crisis; iTunes Store (2003); YouTube (2005); Spotify (2008); India's JioSaavn and Gaana; TikTok and Instagram Reels shape hits; vinyl revival; global K-pop, Latin and Afrobeats; AI music tools (2020s).

☐ **Industry today**: global recorded music revenue reached **US$31.7 billion in 2025**, up 6.4%, with streaming about 70% of revenue and 837 million paid subscription users (IFPI *Global Music Report 2026*, March 2026).

MUS-15 How technology changed listening

Before you start — MUS-15. Each new technology changed what music sounded like, how long songs were, who could make them and who could hear them. **See also:** TEC (audio technology).

☐ **MUS-15.1 Notation and printing**: music could travel without the musician.

☐ **MUS-15.2 Acoustic recording** (1877–1925): singers shouted into horns; loud voices like Gauhar Jaan's recorded best.

☐ **MUS-15.3 Electrical recording and microphones** (from 1925): soft "crooning" became possible.

☐ **MUS-15.4 Radio** (1920s): BBC (1922), Indian Broadcasting Company (1927), All India Radio (1936), Radio Ceylon's *Binaca Geetmala* (1952, hosted by Ameen Sayani), Vividh Bharati (1957).

☐ **MUS-15.5 Magnetic tape and multitrack** (1940s–60s): editing, overdubbing, the studio as an instrument.

☐ **MUS-15.6 The LP and the single** (1948–49): albums and 7-inch hits.

☐ **MUS-15.7 The electric guitar and amplification**: Les Paul, Fender (1950s); feedback and distortion as sound.

☐ **MUS-15.8 Synthesizers, drum machines and samplers** (1960s–80s): Moog, Roland TR-808 (1980), sampling in hip-hop.

☐ **MUS-15.9 The cassette and the Walkman** (Sony, 1979): personal music on the move; cheap local music in India.

☐ **MUS-15.10 Digital audio**: the CD (1982), MIDI (1983), digital audio workstations, Auto-Tune (1997).

☐ **MUS-15.11 The internet**: MP3, file-sharing, downloads, streaming, playlists and algorithms.

☐ **MUS-15.12 AI**: stem separation, generative music, voice cloning; debates on rights (MUS-21.4).

PART 5 — PEOPLE OF MUSIC

About this Part. A selection of composers, performers, producers and teachers who shaped music, sorted by tradition. Each name grows into a profile page on the website. Gharana family trees appear on the pages of each gharana.

MUS-16 Composers, performers and creators

☐ MUS-16.1 Indian classical masters

☐ **Composers and theorists**: Bharata, Matanga, Sharngadeva, Amir Khusrau, Tansen, Sadarang, Purandara Dasa, the Carnatic Trinity, Swathi Thirunal, V. N. Bhatkhande, V. D. Paluskar.

☐ **Vocalists**: Abdul Karim Khan, Faiyaz Khan, Bade Ghulam Ali Khan, Kesarbai Kerkar, Mallikarjun Mansur, Kumar Gandharva, Bhimsen Joshi, Gangubai Hangal, Kishori Amonkar, Pandit Jasraj, M. S. Subbulakshmi, M. Balamuralikrishna, Semmangudi Srinivasa Iyer, D. K. Pattammal.

☐ **Instrumentalists**: Allauddin Khan, Ravi Shankar, Ali Akbar Khan, Annapurna Devi, Vilayat Khan, Bismillah Khan, Hariprasad Chaurasia, Shivkumar Sharma, Zakir Hussain, Alla Rakha, Lalgudi Jayaraman, U. Srinivas, Amjad Ali Khan, N. Rajam (violin).

☐ MUS-16.2 Indian film and popular music

☐ **Composers**: Naushad, S. D. Burman, R. D. Burman, Shankar–Jaikishan, Madan Mohan, Salil Chowdhury, Laxmikant–Pyarelal, M. S. Viswanathan, Ilaiyaraaja, A. R. Rahman, M. M. Keeravani, Pritam, Amit Trivedi, Anirudh Ravichander.

☐ **Singers**: K. L. Saigal, Noor Jehan, Lata Mangeshkar (Bharat Ratna 2001; 1929–2022), Asha Bhosle, Mohammed Rafi, Kishore Kumar, Mukesh, Manna Dey, Hemant Kumar, Bhupen Hazarika (Bharat Ratna 2019), K. J. Yesudas, S. P. Balasubrahmanyam, S. Janaki, K. S. Chithra, Sonu Nigam, Shreya Ghoshal, Arijit Singh.

☐ **Lyricists**: Sahir Ludhianvi, Shailendra, Kavi Pradeep ("Aye Mere Watan Ke Logon"), Majrooh Sultanpuri, Gulzar, Javed Akhtar, Kannadasan, Vairamuthu, Sirivennela Seetharama Sastry.

☐ MUS-16.3 Western classical composers

☐ Hildegard of Bingen, Palestrina, Monteverdi, Bach, Handel, Vivaldi, Haydn, Mozart, Beethoven, Schubert, Chopin, Liszt, Clara Schumann, Verdi, Wagner, Brahms, Tchaikovsky, Dvořák, Debussy, Mahler, Ravel, Stravinsky, Schoenberg, Shostakovich, Gershwin, John Cage, Philip Glass, John Williams; conductors such as Zubin Mehta (born in Bombay) and Mehli Mehta.

☐ MUS-16.4 Popular music legends of the world

☐ Louis Armstrong, Billie Holiday, Ella Fitzgerald, Frank Sinatra, Elvis Presley, Ray Charles, The Beatles, Bob Dylan, Aretha Franklin, Jimi Hendrix, Bob Marley, Fela Kuti, Umm Kulthum, Édith Piaf, Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan, Michael Jackson, Madonna, Prince, Whitney Houston, Freddie Mercury (born Farrokh Bulsara in Zanzibar, schooled in Panchgani, India), Shakira, Beyoncé, Taylor Swift, BTS, Bad Bunny.

☐ MUS-16.5 Producers, engineers and behind-the-scenes creators

☐ George Martin (the Beatles' producer), Quincy Jones, Phil Spector (wall of sound), Lee "Scratch" Perry (dub), Rick Rubin, Max Martin (writer of more Billboard number 1 hits than almost anyone), Dr. Dre; in India, arrangers and sound engineers such as Kersi Lord, Enoch Daniels, Anthony Gonsalves, H. Sridhar and the film orchestra musicians.

☐ MUS-16.6 Scholars, collectors and teachers

☐ Ethnomusicologists and archivists: Alan Lomax, Béla Bartók, Komal Kothari (Rupayan Sansthan, Rajasthan), Ashok Ranade, B. R. Deodhar, Vijay Kichlu (ITC Sangeet Research Academy, 1977), the Archive of Indian Music (Vikram Sampath); music educators and gurukuls.

PART 6 — AWARDS, CHARTS AND RECORDS

About this Part. Each award has the same card: who gives it, since when, for what, the first winner, landmark winners and the latest winner, with the date checked. Latest results were checked on **3 November 2026**. Industry awards (charts, MTV, Billboard) measure popularity, not quality.

MUS-17 International music awards

☐ MUS-17.1 Grammy Awards

Given by the **Recording Academy** (USA) since **1959** (for 1958 recordings), voted by music professionals, in about 90 to 95 categories. **First Album of the Year:** Henry Mancini, *The Music from Peter Gunn*. **Landmarks:** Ravi Shankar (1967, first Indian winner); Beyoncé holds the record for most Grammys won by any artist; Zakir Hussain won three in one night (2024). **Indian winners include** Ravi Shankar, Vishwa Mohan Bhatt (1994, *A Meeting by the River*), Zakir Hussain, A. R. Rahman (two in 2010), Ricky Kej (three), Falguni Shah (2022), Shankar Mahadevan and Shakti (2024); Anoushka Shankar has had many nominations. **Latest (68th Grammys, 1 February 2026):** Album of the Year to **Bad Bunny**, *DeBÍ TiRAR MáS FOToS*, widely reported as the first all-Spanish-language album to win; Best New Artist **Olivia Dean**; Best Global Music Album *Caetano e Bethânia Ao Vivo* (Caetano Veloso and Maria Bethânia). **Tags:** #grammy

☐ MUS-17.2 Other international awards

- ☐ **Polar Music Prize** (Sweden, 1992; founded by Stig Anderson of ABBA; first laureates Paul McCartney and the Baltic states): "music's Nobel". Ravi Shankar (1998) is the Indian laureate. **Latest verified (2025):** Queen, Herbie Hancock and Barbara Hannigan.
- ☐ **Latin Grammy Awards** (2000): Spanish- and Portuguese-language music.
- ☐ **Kennedy Center Honors** (USA, 1978) and the **Rock and Roll Hall of Fame** (1983; first inductees 1986).
- ☐ **WOMEX Award** and **Songlines Music Awards**: world music.
- ☐ **Gramophone Awards** (UK, 1977): classical recordings.
- ☐ **Pulitzer Prize for Music** (1943; Kendrick Lamar 2018).
- ☐ **MTV Video Music Awards** (1984), **Billboard Music Awards**, **MAMA** (Asia), **BET Awards**: popularity and industry awards.
- ☐ **UNESCO International Music Council's Music Rights Awards** and the **Aga Khan Music Awards** (2019).

MUS-18 National music awards, country by country

☐ MUS-18.1 India

- ☐ **Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards** (founded 1952): India's national honour for performing artists in music, dance and theatre, given every year in Hindustani and Carnatic vocal and instrumental music, folk and other fields; the **Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (Akademi Ratna)** is the highest. **Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar** (2006) for young artists.
- ☐ **Bharat Ratna to musicians**: M. S. Subbulakshmi (1998), Ravi Shankar (1999), Lata Mangeshkar (2001), Bismillah Khan (2001), Bhimsen Joshi (2009), Bhupen Hazarika (2019).
- ☐ **Padma awards**: many musicians each year.
- ☐ **Sangita Kalanidhi** (Madras Music Academy, 1942): the top title in Carnatic music, given at the December Season; first recipient Mysore Vasudevachar. **Latest:** 2025 to violinist **R. K. Shriramkumar**; vocalist and veena artist **Jayanthi Kumaresh** is named for the Academy's 100th conference (December 2026–January 2027).
- ☐ **Tansen Samman** (Madhya Pradesh government, 1980): Hindustani music, at the Tansen Samaroh in Gwalior.
- ☐ **Kalidas Samman** (Madhya Pradesh), **Sangeet Martand**, state Sangeet Natak Akademi awards.
- ☐ **Film music awards**: National Film Awards (Best Music Direction, Best Playback Singer, Best Lyrics), Filmfare (Best Music Director from 1954, first Naushad for *Baiju Bawra*), IIFA, Mirchi Music Awards.
- ☐ **Dadasaheb Phalke Award** to musicians: Naushad (1981), Lata Mangeshkar (1989), Bhupen Hazarika (1992), Asha Bhosle (2000), Manna Dey (2007).

Award Register — Bharat Ratna and other top honours for Indian musicians

Year	Musician	Tradition	Honour	Note	Why it matters
1967	Ravi Shankar	Hindustani (sitar)	Grammy (*West Meets East*)	First Indian Grammy	Global ambassador of Indian music
1998	M. S. Subbulakshmi	Carnatic vocal	Bharat Ratna; earlier Ramon Magsaysay Award (1974)	First musician to receive Bharat Ratna	Voice of devotion
1998	Ravi Shankar	Hindustani	Polar Music Prize	—	—
1999	Ravi Shankar	Hindustani	Bharat Ratna	—	—
2001	Lata Mangeshkar	Film playback	Bharat Ratna	—	"Nightingale of India"
2001	Bismillah Khan	Shehnai	Bharat Ratna	—	Made shehnai a concert instrument
2009	A. R. Rahman	Film score	Two Oscars, Golden Globe	First Indian composer Oscar	Global film music
2009	Bhimsen Joshi	Hindustani (Kirana)	Bharat Ratna	—	—
2019	Bhupen Hazarika	Assamese song, film	Bharat Ratna (posthumous)	—	"Bard of the Brahmaputra"
2023	M. M. Keeravani and Chandrabose	Telugu film song	Oscar, Best Original Song	—	"Naatu Naatu"
2024	Zakir Hussain	Tabla	Three Grammys in one night	—	Most for an Indian in a single ceremony

☐ MUS-18.2 United Kingdom and Europe

☐ **BRIT Awards** (1977), **Mercury Prize** (1992; first winner Primal Scream, *Screamadelica*) for the album of the year. **Latest (2026): RAYE**, *This Music May Contain Hope* (October 2026). **Ivor Novello Awards** (1956, songwriting). **Eurovision**. **Echo / Opus Klassik** (Germany), **Victoires de la Musique** (France).

☐ MUS-18.3 Americas, Asia and Africa

☐ **Canada**: Juno Awards (1970), Polaris Music Prize (2006).

☐ **Latin America**: Premios Lo Nuestro, Latin Grammys.

☐ **Japan**: Japan Record Award (1959), NHK Kōhaku Uta Gassen (year-end show, 1951).

☐ **South Korea**: Golden Disc Awards (1986), Melon Music Awards, MAMA.

☐ **Pakistan**: Lux Style Awards (music). **Bangladesh**: Channel i Music Awards.

☐ **Africa**: Kora Awards, The Headies (Nigeria, 2006), South African Music Awards.

☐ **Australia**: ARIA Awards (1987).

MUS-19 Charts, sales and records

Before you start — MUS-19. Charts measure what was bought, streamed or played, by rules that change over time. Sales claims are often estimates. **See also:** BOK-17 (book best-sellers).

☐ **MUS-19.1 Major charts**: Billboard Hot 100 (1958) and Billboard 200; UK Official Charts (1952); Billboard Global 200 (2020); Spotify and YouTube charts; India's IMI charts and Radio Mirchi lists; the historic *Binaca Geetmala* countdown (1952–1994).

☐ **MUS-19.2 Best-selling artists (estimates)**: The Beatles, Elvis Presley and Michael Jackson are usually listed at the top; Taylor Swift was IFPI's Global Recording Artist of the Year for a record sixth time (2025).

☐ **MUS-19.3 Best-selling albums (estimates)**: *Thriller* (often cited as the best-selling album ever), *Back in Black*, *The Dark Side of the Moon*; in India, film soundtracks such as *Aashiqui* (1990) and *Maine Pyar Kiya* sold in tens of millions of cassettes by label claims.

☐ **MUS-19.4 Records and curiosities**: Guinness listed Lata Mangeshkar (1974) and later Asha Bhosle (2011) for the most studio recordings; "Happy Birthday to You" is among the most sung songs; John Cage's *4′33″* (1952) is a piece of silence; *As Slow as Possible* (Cage) is being performed in Halberstadt, Germany, until 2640.

PART 7 — THE CRAFT AND THE BUSINESS OF MUSIC

About this Part. How music is made, recorded and earned from: composing, arranging, recording, mixing, mastering and live sound; then labels, royalties and copyright.

MUS-20 Making music: composition to concert

Before you start — MUS-20. A song goes from an idea to a performance or a recording through a chain of crafts. In Indian classical music much of this happens live, in improvisation; in film and pop it happens in the studio. **See also:** INS (instruments), TEC (audio technology).

- ☐ **MUS-20.1 Composition and songwriting**: melody first or lyrics first (Indian film songs often use a "tune first" method); hooks, structure (MUS-13.2); bandish composition in classical music.
- ☐ **MUS-20.2 Lyrics**: rhyme, metre and meaning; Urdu–Hindi film poetry; Carnatic sahitya (lyric) and its languages.
- ☐ **MUS-20.3 Arranging and orchestration**: choosing instruments and parts; the film orchestra of Bombay (strings, mandolin, accordion, santoor) and its arrangers.
- ☐ **MUS-20.4 Improvisation**: alap, taan, swara kalpana, jazz solos, freestyle rap.
- ☐ **MUS-20.5 Recording**: microphones, isolation, multitracking, home studios, the digital audio workstation (DAW: Pro Tools, Logic, Ableton, FL Studio).
- ☐ **MUS-20.6 Mixing and mastering**: balancing levels, EQ, compression, reverb, panning; mastering for loudness and formats; the "loudness war".
- ☐ **MUS-20.7 Live sound and concerts**: PA systems, monitors, acoustics of halls (Shanmukhananda Hall, Mumbai; the Royal Albert Hall), the sabha culture of Chennai.
- ☐ **MUS-20.8 Practice and pedagogy**: riyaz (daily practice), guru–shishya parampara, conservatories (Juilliard, Royal Academy of Music), university music departments (Banaras Hindu University, Kalakshetra, Bhatkhande Sanskriti Vishwavidyalaya, Lucknow), graded exams (Trinity, ABRSM; Gandharva Mahavidyalaya in India).

MUS-21 The music industry, royalties and copyright

Before you start — MUS-21. Music makes money from recordings, publishing (songwriting rights), live shows, licensing (films, ads, games) and merchandise. In India, film-music labels have long dominated. **See also:** BOK-19.5 Copyright.

- ☐ **MUS-21.1 Record labels**: the three majors (Universal Music Group, Sony Music, Warner Music); independent labels; India's T-Series (founded by Gulshan Kumar; its YouTube channel is among the most subscribed in the world), Saregama (from the Gramophone Company of India, HMV), Tips, Zee Music, Sony Music India, Think Music, Aditya Music, Lahari.
- ☐ **MUS-21.2 How artists earn**: royalties from streams (fractions of a cent per play), performance royalties (radio, TV, venues), mechanical royalties, synchronisation (sync) fees, concerts and merchandise.
- ☐ **MUS-21.3 Collecting societies**: IPRS (Indian Performing Right Society, 1969; reformed after the Copyright Amendment Act, 2012, which gave lyricists and composers a share of royalties), PPL India, ASCAP and BMI (USA), PRS (UK).
- ☐ **MUS-21.4 Copyright and music**: two rights in every recording (the composition and the sound recording); cover versions and remixes; sampling disputes; the 2012 Indian amendment; AI training and voice-cloning cases.
- ☐ **MUS-21.5 Streaming economics**: Spotify, Apple Music, YouTube Music, Amazon Music, JioSaavn, Gaana; playlists as gatekeepers; arguments for fairer payment ("user-centric" models).
- ☐ **MUS-21.6 Live music business**: festivals, tours, ticketing; India's growing concert market (Coldplay's Ahmedabad shows, January 2025, among the largest audiences of the tour).

PART 8 — IDEAS: MUSIC, MIND, PHILOSOPHY AND SOCIETY

About this Part. Why music moves us, what it does to the brain and body, and what it does in society. Claims come with their evidence; open debates are flagged.

MUS-22 Music, mind and society

Before you start — MUS-22. Philosophers from Plato and Bharata to modern neuroscientists have asked why music has such power. **See also:** BOK-20.1 Rasa theory, MOV-19.

☐ MUS-22.1 Philosophy and aesthetics of music

☐ **Nada yoga and nada brahma**: sound as a path to the divine (Indian tradition).

☐ **Rasa and bhava in music**: Bharata's rasa theory applied to raga (MUS-00.04).

☐ **Pythagoras and the "music of the spheres"**: harmony as cosmic order.

☐ **Plato**: some modes build character, others corrupt it; music in education.

☐ **Confucius**: music as moral harmony and good government.

☐ **Modern views**: Eduard Hanslick (music is "tonally moving forms"), Theodor Adorno (critique of the pop industry), John Cage (silence and chance), Christopher Small's idea of "musicking" (music as an activity, not a thing).

☐ MUS-22.2 Music and the brain

☐ **Pleasure**: peak moments in music release dopamine (Salimpoor and colleagues, 2011); "chills" or frisson.

☐ **Prediction**: the brain enjoys guessing what comes next, and being surprised (David Huron, *Sweet Anticipation*, 2006).

☐ **Memory**: music memories survive even in advanced dementia; the documentary *Alive Inside* (2014).

☐ **Musical training** and brain changes; the "Mozart effect" claim (1993) was largely not confirmed.

☐ **Amusia** (tone deafness) affects a small percentage of people.

☐ **Books**: Oliver Sacks, *Musicophilia* (2007); Daniel Levitin, *This Is Your Brain on Music* (2006).

☐ MUS-22.3 Music therapy and well-being

☐ Clinical music therapy for stroke, autism, depression and pain; raga therapy claims in India (some practised widely, with limited rigorous evidence so far); singing and breathing; lullabies for babies; group singing and loneliness.

☐ MUS-22.4 Music and society

☐ **Identity**: national anthems ("Jana Gana Mana", adopted 1950), regional pride, diaspora music (bhangra in Britain, chutney in Trinidad).

☐ **Protest and freedom songs**: "Vande Mataram", "Sare Jahan Se Achha" (Iqbal), "We Shall Overcome" (sung in Hindi as "Hum Honge Kamyab"), Bob Marley, Fela Kuti, Victor Jara, Faiz's "Hum Dekhenge" (sung by Iqbal Bano, 1986).

☐ **Caste, gender and music**: hereditary musician communities (Mirasi, Manganiyar, devadasi and isai vellalar traditions), women performers' struggles, debates on access to Carnatic music (T. M. Krishna, *A Southern Music*, 2013).

☐ **Music and religion**: chant, bhajan, qawwali, hymns; debates on music in some religious traditions.

☐ **Music and technology**: who controls the algorithms, AI and authorship (MUS-00.08).

PART 9 — REVIEWS AND VOICES

About this Part. Three kinds of pages: (1) **Critics' Corner** on great music critics; (2) **The critics said, I say** on albums, songs and concerts, summarising critics in my own words with links, then my view; (3) **My Review Desk**. I never copy reviews; I quote a few words at most, with credit.

MUS-23 Critics' Corner: great music critics and writers

☐ **MUS-23.1 World critics**: E. T. A. Hoffmann (on Beethoven), Robert Schumann (critic-composer), George Bernard Shaw (music critic), Virgil Thomson, Alex Ross (*The Rest Is Noise*, 2007), Lester Bangs, Greil Marcus, Robert Christgau ("Dean of American rock critics"), Ann Powers, Simon Reynolds; *Rolling Stone* (1967), *NME* (1952), *Pitchfork* (1996), *Gramophone* (1923), *The Wire*, *Songlines*.

☐ **MUS-23.2 Indian critics and writers**: Vamanrao Deshpande, Ashok Ranade, Mohan Nadkarni, Raghava R. Menon, Subbudu (Carnatic critic, *The Statesman*), S. Kalidas, Namita Devidayal (*The Music Room*), Sheila Dhar, Raju Bharatan (film music), Ganesh Anantharaman (*Bollywood Melodies*), Shubha Mudgal (as writer), Vikram Sampath (*My Name Is Gauhar Jaan*); *Sruti* magazine (1983).

☐ **MUS-23.3 Ratings and listener data**: Metacritic, Album of the Year, Rate Your Music, streaming counts; why popularity is not quality.

MUS-24 The critics said, I say (page template)

1. **The work in two lines**: title, artist, year, label, genre, length (no spoilers needed, but context first).
2. **What the critics said**: 3 to 5 named reviews, each summarised in one or two lines of my own words, with links and dates.
3. **Where they agree and disagree**.
4. **What I say**: my own listening and view (link to MUS-25).
5. **If you liked this, listen next**: three linked works, plus instruments used (INS) and film links (MOV).

MUS-25 My Review Desk (Kritikesh's music-review template)

☐ **Header**: title, artist, composer, year, label, genre, language, raga and tala (if classical), where to listen (dated).

☐ **My one-line verdict**.

☐ **What it is**: context and what to listen for.

☐ **What worked for me**: voice, melody, rhythm, lyrics, production, emotion.

☐ **What did not**.

☐ **Rasa meter**: the moods it served.

☐ **Best moment**: a timestamp.

☐ **Who should listen**: mood, setting, experience level.

☐ **My rating** on a clear five-point scale.

☐ **Tags and listen-next links**.

PART 10 — LISTENING, LEARNING AND COMMUNITY

MUS-26 The music lover's practical guide

☐ **MUS-26.1 How to start listening to Indian classical music**: begin with instrumental music and short recordings; learn to recognise the alap and the sam; five beginner ragas (Yaman, Bhupali, Bhairavi, Kafi, Desh) and five Carnatic ragas (Mohanam, Kalyani, Hamsadhwani, Shankarabharanam, Kharaharapriya); attend a small baithak.

☐ **MUS-26.2 How to start with Western classical, jazz and world music**: starter lists (each linked to registers).

☐ **MUS-26.3 How to listen closely**: five questions (what is the pulse, what is the melody doing, who is leading, how does it change, how does it make me feel).

☐ **MUS-26.4 Learning an instrument or singing**: choosing a teacher, online lessons, riyaz routines, graded exams (links to INS).

☐ **MUS-26.5 Festivals and concert seasons**: Sawai Gandharva Bhimsen Mahotsav (Pune, December, since 1953), the Madras December Season (Music Academy, since 1927–28), Tansen Samaroh (Gwalior), Saptak (Ahmedabad), Dover Lane (Kolkata), Harballabh (Jalandhar, since 1875, among the oldest), Rajasthan International Folk Festival (Jodhpur), Hornbill (Nagaland), NH7 Weekender; Glastonbury, WOMAD (founded by Peter Gabriel, 1982), Montreux Jazz, the BBC Proms, Coachella, Tomorrowland. Check dates every year.

☐ **MUS-26.6 Where to listen legally and free**: All India Radio and Prasar Bharati archives, YouTube channels of labels and archives, Archive of Indian Music, Smithsonian Folkways, public radio, library music collections. Always dated.

☐ **MUS-26.7 Museums of music**: Sangeet Natak Akademi's museum (Delhi), the Indian Music Experience Museum (Bengaluru, 2019), Musical Instrument Museum (Phoenix), Grammy Museum, Beethoven House (Bonn).

☐ **MUS-26.8 Listening well**: protect your hearing (keep volume moderate; the WHO's Make Listening Safe guidance), support artists by buying tickets and music, avoid piracy.

PART 11 — NAVIGATION: TAGS, LINKS AND THE SITE MAP

MUS-27 Tag dictionary

☐ **Tradition and region**: #hindustani #carnatic #folk #rajasthan #punjab #bengal #arabic #persian #kpop #jpop #gamelan #african #latin #caribbean #european #celtic and others.

☐ **Language**: #hindi #urdu #tamil #telugu #malayalam #kannada #bengali #marathi #punjabi #bhojpuri #rajasthani #english #spanish #korean #arabic and others.

☐ **Genre**: every genre in MUS-08 and MUS-09 (#jazz #blues #rock #pop #hiphop #electronic #reggae #metal #qawwali #ghazal #thumri #bhajan #filmmusic).

☐ **Era and decade**: #ancient #medieval #baroque #romantic #1930s to #2020s.

☐ **Raga and tala**: one tag per raga and tala page (#yaman #bhairavi #teentaal #aditala).

☐ **Instrument**: links to INS tags (#sitar #tabla #veena #guitar #piano).

☐ **Award**: #grammy #mercury #sangeetnatak #sangitakalanidhi #nationalfilmaward #filmfare.

☐ **Person**: one tag per profiled musician.

☐ **Mood and rasa**: #calm #devotional #romantic #dance #melancholy #energetic #shringara #karuna #veera #shanta and the other rasas.

☐ **Listener level**: #beginner #listener #musicnerd.

MUS-28 Cross-links and the website site map

☐ **MUS-28.1 Cross-topic links**: Musical Instruments (INS) for every instrument; Movies (film songs and scores: MOV); Books (lyrics and poetry: BOK-06); Technology (audio, recording, streaming, AI: TEC); Sports (anthems, stadium songs: SPT); Curriculum Index (Art and Culture: music of India) and Exam Guide (music and dance questions in RPSC/RSSB).

☐ **MUS-28.2 Suggested web addresses**: /music/ (home, Gateway), /music/why-music-moves-us/<leaf>/ , /music/world/<region>/<tradition>/ , /music/india/classical/<system>/ , /music/india/folk/<state>/ , /music/india/film/<industry>/ , /music/genres/<genre>/ , /music/basics/<topic>/ , /music/ragas/<raga>/ , /music/talas/<tala>/ , /music/history/<era>/ , /music/people/<name>/ , /music/awards/<award>/ , /music/industry/<topic>/ , /music/ideas/<topic>/ , /music/reviews/<work>/ , /music/guide/<topic>/ .

☐ **MUS-28.3 Search phrases to own**: "difference between Hindustani and Carnatic music", "list of ragas and their time", "what is a thaat", "types of tala", "gharanas of Hindustani music", "folk music of Rajasthan", "first Indian film song", "Grammy 2026 winners", "Indian Grammy winners list", "types of music genres", "how to start listening to classical music", with Hindi lines ("raag kitne prakar ke hote hain", "rajasthan ke lok geet").

PART 12 — SOURCES, CREDITS AND EDITOR'S NOTES

MUS-S Sources and credits

Knowledge belongs to the people who made it. These are the sources this index stands on; every page on the website will cite its own.

☐ **Reference works**: *Grove Music Online* (Oxford); Encyclopaedia Britannica (music entries); *The Garland Encyclopedia of World Music* (vol. 5: South Asia, ed. Alison Arnold, 2000); Bonnie C. Wade, *Music in India: The Classical Traditions*; Joep Bor (ed.), *The Raga Guide* (1999); Deepak Raja, *Hindustani Music*; T. M. Krishna, *A Southern Music* (2013); Ashok Ranade, *Hindustani Music* (NBT); Ganesh Anantharaman, *Bollywood Melodies* (2008); Alex Ross, *The Rest Is Noise* (2007); Ted Gioia, *Music: A Subversive History* (2019).

☐ **Institutions**: Sangeet Natak Akademi; ITC Sangeet Research Academy; Madras Music Academy; Prasar Bharati Archives; Archive of Indian Music; UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage lists; Smithsonian Folkways; British Library Sound Archive.

☐ **Science**: Oliver Sacks, *Musicophilia* (2007); Daniel Levitin, *This Is Your Brain on Music* (2006); David Huron, *Sweet Anticipation* (2006); McDermott and colleagues, *Nature* (2016, Tsimane' listeners); Mehr and colleagues (2018–2019, universal song forms); Salimpoor and colleagues, *Nature Neuroscience* (2011); Steven Mithen, *The Singing Neanderthals* (2005).

☐ **Industry data**: IFPI *Global Music Report 2026* (March 2026; US$31.7 billion in 2025, 837 million paid subscription users); Billboard; Official Charts Company; Indian Music Industry (IMI).

☐ **Awards checked (3 November 2026)**: grammy.com and Channels TV / Statesman winners lists (68th Grammys, 1 February 2026); polarmusicprize.org (2025 laureates); Official Charts and Music Week (Mercury Prize 2026, RAYE); GS Times and Utkarsh current-affairs reports (Sangita Kalanidhi 2025 and 2026); The Hindu (Music Academy announcements).

MUS-E Editor's notes (corrections and decisions on the brief)

1. **"Every song" cannot fit in one booklet**: the booklet gives landmark registers and a plan to grow year-wise lists on the website (MUS-07.3).
2. **Raga time theory** is presented as a living tradition of feeling, not a scientific law, and legends (Tansen's Deepak lighting lamps) are marked as legends.
3. **Attributions to Amir Khusrau** (sitar, tabla, qawwali) are marked as traditional; historians debate several of them. The Instruments index (INS) explains the sitar and tabla origins in detail.
4. **"World music"** is explained as a marketing label, not a genre.
5. **Sales and streaming figures** are given only with source and date.
6. **Latest results** were checked on 3 November 2026; the 2026 Polar Music Prize was not verified, so the 2025 laureates are given. Some reports disagreed on the 2026 Grammy Song of the Year, so only the clearly reported winners are listed.
7. **Added beyond the brief**: the physics of sound, notation systems, technology of listening, the music business and royalties, music and the brain, protest music, caste and gender in music, museums, hearing safety, tag dictionary and site map.

MUS-T My Listening Tracker

Use the ☐ boxes across the booklet to tick what you have heard or explored. A simple tracker for each Part: Part · Sections · Explored · Date started · Date finished.

Progress tracker

Part	Sections	Explored ☐	Started	Finished

PART 0 — THE INTRODUCTION TWIG: WHY DOES VIBRATING AIR MAKE US CRY, DANCE OR PRAY?	10			
PART 1 — MUSIC OF THE WORLD	7			
PART 2 — GENRES AND STYLES	2			
PART 3 — THE BUILDING BLOCKS OF MUSIC	4			
PART 4 — HISTORY AND TIMELINE	2			
PART 5 — PEOPLE OF MUSIC	1			
PART 6 — AWARDS, CHARTS AND RECORDS	3			
PART 7 — THE CRAFT AND THE BUSINESS OF MUSIC	2			
PART 8 — IDEAS: MUSIC, MIND, PHILOSOPHY AND SOCIETY	1			
PART 9 — REVIEWS AND VOICES	3			
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